3. These special provisions are not applicable to tribal area of Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram or Tripura as included in the Sixth Schedule to the Constitution and the area covered under "The Inner Line" notified under the Bengal Eastern Frontier Regulation, 1873.

Before the enactment of the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019, the migrants belonging to Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi or Christian communities from Afghanistan, Bangladesh or Pakistan who entered into India without valid passport and other travel documents or if the validity of their passport and other documents had expired were reggarded as illegal migrants and were ineligible to apply for Indian citizenship under the provisions (registration or naturalisaiton) of the Citizenship Act, 1955.

In 2015, the Central Government exempted the said migrants from the adverse penal consequences of the passport (Entry into India) Act, 1920 and the Foreigners Act, 1946. Subsequently, in 2016, the Central Government also made them eligible for long term visa to stay in India.

With the enactment of the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019, the said migrants became eligible for Indian citizenship. This Act came into force on January 10, 2020.

 **Loss of Citizenship**

The Citizenship Act (1955) prescribes three ways of losing citizenship whether acquired under the Act or prior to it under the Constitution, viz, renunciation, termination and deprivation:

1. By Renunciation Any citizen of India of full age and capacity can make a declaration renouncing his/her Indian citizenship. Upon the registration of that declaration, that person ceases to be a citizen of India. However, if such a declaration is made during a war in which India is engaged, its registration shall be withheld by the Central Government.

Further, when a person renounces his/her Indian citizenship, every minor child of that person also loses Indian citizenship. However, when such a child attains the age of eighteen, he/she may (within one year) resume Indian citizenship.

2. By Termination When an Indian citizen voluntarily (consciously, knowingly and without duress, undue influence or compulsion) acquires the citizenship of another country, his/her Indian citizenship automatically terminates. This provision, however, does not apply during a war in which India is engaged.

3. By Deprivation It is a compulsory termination of Indian citizenship by the Central government, if:

1. the citizen has obtained the citizenship by fraud:
2. the citizen has shown disloyalty to the Constitution of India:
3. the citizen has unlawfully traded or communicated with the enemy during a war;
4. the citizen has, within five years after registration or naturalisation, been imprisoned in any country for two years; and
5. the citizen has been ordinarily resident out of India for seven years continuously.[9]

OVERSEAS CITIZENSHIP OF INDIA